

Michael Soga

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DevOps Engineer/Cloud Solution Architect

Seasoned DevOps Engineer and Cloud Solution Architect with 6+ years of experience architecting, automating, and optimizing mission-critical deployments on AWS and Azure. Proven ability to lead complex infrastructure projects from concept to completion, design scalable cloud-native applications, and streamline CI/CD pipelines to accelerate delivery. Expert in containerization, Infrastructure as Code (IaC), DevSecOps, and modern cloud architectures (microservices, serverless computing). Adept at collaborating across departments to align business goals with engineering excellence.

SKILLS

Agile, Analytical Thinking, ARM Templates, AWS, Azure, Bash, Bicep, Bitbucket, CI/CD, CloudFormation, Cloud Solution Architect, CloudWatch, Communication, Confluence, Containerization, DevOps Engineer, DevSecOps, Docker, ELK Stack, Git, GitHub, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Grafana, Helm, IaC, IAM Policies, Jenkins, JIRA, Key Management, KMS, Kubernetes, Microservices, .NET, NIST, PowerShell, Problem Solving, Prometheus, Python, Scrum, Serverless Computing, Serverless Framework, SQL, Team Leadership, Teamwork, Terraform, Time Management

WORK EXPERIENCE

NextEra

11/2020 – Present

DevOps Engineer/Cloud Architect

Houston, TX

- Architected hybrid-cloud solutions across AWS and Azure, improving service uptime by 40% and reducing outages by 30%.
- Deployed 25+ containerized microservices using Kubernetes (AKS/EKS), supporting 99.9% SLA requirements.
- Built CI/CD pipelines with GitLab CI and Jenkins, reducing deployment time from 2 hours to under 10 minutes.
- Automated infrastructure provisioning with Terraform, cutting manual provisioning by 85% and ensuring consistent environments.
- Migrated 15+ legacy apps to Azure Kubernetes Service and App Services, reducing operational costs by 25%.
- Set up observability using Prometheus, Grafana, and ELK Stack, improving issue detection time by 60%.
- Containerized .NET and Python apps for dev/test pipelines, reducing QA cycle time by 35%.
- Implemented IAM policies and KMS for 100% encryption coverage across sensitive workloads.
- Created 10+ architecture diagrams and operational runbooks to improve team onboarding and incident response.
- Researched and piloted 5+ new DevOps tools, increasing overall DevOps adoption across 3 teams.

Amazon Web Services (AWS)

08/2017 – 08/2020

DevOps Engineer

Houston, TX

- Developed CI/CD pipelines in Jenkins and GitLab, improving release frequency from weekly to daily.
- Containerized applications with Docker and Kubernetes, streamlining deployments across 4 environments.
- Automated disaster recovery for critical apps, reducing RTO by 50% and RPO to under 10 minutes.
- Designed serverless APIs using AWS Lambda and API Gateway, handling 100K+ monthly requests with zero downtime.
- Provisioned AWS infrastructure via CloudFormation templates, increasing compliance by 40%.
- Cut cloud spend by 20% via resource right-sizing, auto-scaling policies, and storage optimization.

- Created centralized monitoring with CloudWatch and ELK, improving mean time to resolution (MTTR) by 45%.
- Integrated security scanning tools into CI pipelines, reducing security misconfiguration by 70%.
- Partnered with PMs and architects to align infrastructure roadmaps with quarterly product goals.

PROJECTS

Cloud Cost Optimization Dashboard

Designed and implemented a real-time cloud usage dashboard using AWS CloudWatch, Lambda, and QuickSight. Enabled leadership to track spend trends, identify idle resources, and implement cost-saving strategies.

Azure Migration Accelerator

Led the design of an Azure-native landing zone architecture using Bicep, Azure DevOps, and AKS. Reduced on-prem-to-cloud migration time by 30 and improved security posture with native Azure tools.

DevOps Automation Framework

Developed a modular automation framework using Terraform and Ansible to standardize CI/CD pipeline setups. Accelerated pipeline rollouts and reduced onboarding time for new developers.

Key Achievements

- Streamlined cloud infrastructure costs by 25% through optimization of EC2 instance types, auto-scaling policies, and reserved instances.
- Executed a cross-region disaster recovery solution for critical services, achieving a 99.99% availability target.
- Mentored and upskilled a team of 5 junior engineers in DevOps best practices, IaC, and CI/CD automation tools.
- Created a reusable DevOps toolkit adopted across 3 business units, reducing setup time for new projects by 60%.
- Orchestrated security hardening across Kubernetes clusters, reducing vulnerability exposure score by 70% over 2 quarters.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Computer science

University of Houston • GPA: 3.6

Houston, TX • 09/2013 - 04/2017